

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

Index No.: _____ 2017
Purchased _____ -2017

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CARMEN ROMAN,

Plaintiff,

-against-

Plaintiff designates
BRONX County as the
place of trial.

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD OFFICER
NATALIE COTTER OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD
#027369, TAX REG. #938300, NYPD OFFICER MARK
STEVENSON OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #7312,
TAX REG. #953748, AND OTHER NEW YORK CITY
POLICE OFFICERS ON SAID ARREST AND
INVESTIGATION UNDER DOCKET
#2016BX020759 N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I-V, AS IT
PERTAINS TO THE INCIDENT THAT WAS
ALLEGED TO HAVE OCCURRED ON MAY 12, 2016
AND NO OTHER DATE,

The basis of the venue is where the
tort arose.

SUMMONS

Plaintiff resides at

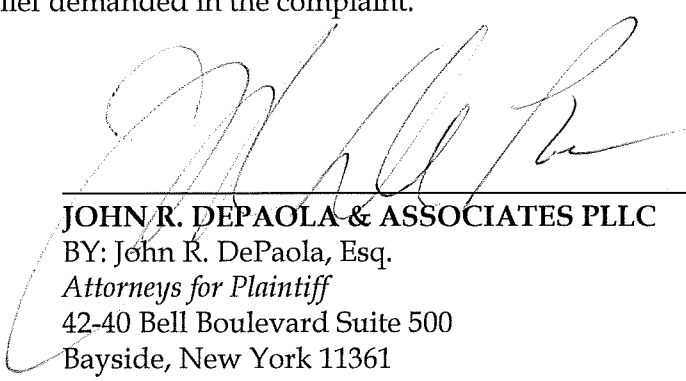
CARMEN ROMAN
1037 Longfellow Avenue
Bronx, New York 10459

Defendants.
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TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED, to answer the complaint in this
action and to serve a copy of your answer, or if the complaint is not served with this
summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's Attorney(s) within 20 days
after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after
the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State
of New York; and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken
against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: Bayside, New York
May 17, 2017



JOHN R. DEPAOLA & ASSOCIATES PLLC

BY: John R. DePaola, Esq.

Attorneys for Plaintiff

42-40 Bell Boulevard Suite 500

Bayside, New York 11361

(718) 281-4000

Defendants' Addresses:

**CORPORATION COUNSEL OF THE
CITY OF NEW YORK**

100 Church Street
New York, New York 10007

**NYPD OFFICER NATALIE COTTER OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #027369, TAX REG.
#938300**

1035 Longwood Ave
Bronx, NY 10459

**NYPD OFFICER MARK STEVENSON OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #7312, TAX REG.
#953748**

1035 Longwood Ave
Bronx, NY 10459

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
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CARMEN ROMAN,

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THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD OFFICER
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N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I-V, AS IT PERTAINS TO
THE INCIDENT THAT WAS ALLEGED TO HAVE
OCCURRED ON MAY 12, 2016 AND NO OTHER
DATE,

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

Defendants.

-----X

CARMEN ROMAN, by his attorneys, JOHN R. DEPAOLA & ASSOCIATES
PLLC, respectfully alleges as follows:

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

1. At all times relevant to this action, Plaintiff, CARMEN ROMAN, was a resident of Bronx County, City and State of New York.
2. At all times mentioned, Defendant, CITY OF NEW YORK, was and is a municipal corporation duly organized and existing by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.
3. Upon information and belief, at all times mentioned, Defendants, NYPD OFFICER NATALIE COTTER OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #027369, TAX REG. #938300, NYPD OFFICER MARK STEVENSON OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #7312, TAX REG. #953748, AND OTHER NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS ON SAID ARREST AND INVESTIGATION UNDER

DOCKET #2016BX020759 N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I-V, AS IT PERTAINS TO THE INCIDENT THAT WAS ALLEGED TO HAVE OCCURRED ON MAY 12, 2016 AND NO OTHER DATE, and at all times herein were acting in such capacity as the agents, servants and employees of the Defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK.

7. On or about May 12, 2016, at approximately 3:00 P.M. in the vicinity of the rear of 1035 Longwood Avenue, County of Bronx, State of New York, the Defendants, NYPD OFFICER NATALIE COTTER OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #027369, TAX REG. #938300, NYPD OFFICER MARK STEVENSON OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #7312, TAX REG. #953748, AND OTHER NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS ON SAID ARREST AND INVESTIGATION UNDER DOCKET #2016BX020759 N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I-V, AS IT PERTAINS TO THE INCIDENT THAT WAS ALLEGED TO HAVE OCCURRED ON MAY 12, 2016 AND NO OTHER DATE, jointly and severally in their capacity as police officers, wrongfully touched, grabbed, handcuffed and seized the Plaintiff, CARMEN ROMAN, in an excessive manner about her person, causing her physical pain and mental suffering. At no time did the Defendants have legal cause to grab, handcuff seize or touch the Plaintiff, nor did the Plaintiff consent to this illegal touching nor was it privileged by law.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

8. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "7" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.
9. On or about May 12, 2016, at approximately 3:00 P.M. in the vicinity of the rear of 1035 Longwood Avenue, County of Bronx, State of New York, the Defendants, NYPD OFFICER NATALIE COTTER OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #027369, TAX REG. #938300, NYPD OFFICER MARK STEVENSON OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #7312, TAX REG. #953748, AND OTHER NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS ON SAID ARREST AND INVESTIGATION UNDER DOCKET #2016BX020759 N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I-V, AS IT PERTAINS TO THE INCIDENT THAT WAS ALLEGED TO HAVE OCCURRED ON MAY 12, 2016 AND NO OTHER DATE, jointly and severally did place Plaintiff, CARMEN ROMAN, in imminent fear of physical contact by approaching the Plaintiff with their loaded firearms, outstretched limbs and other objects which they used to physically seize, strike and restrain the Plaintiff. All of the above actions placed the Plaintiff in imminent fear of physical contact. At no time did the Plaintiff consent to the unlawful actions of the Defendants.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

10. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "9" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.
11. On or about May 12, 2016, at approximately 3:00 P.M. in the vicinity of the rear of 1035 Longwood Avenue, County of Bronx, State of New York, the

Defendants, NYPD OFFICER NATALIE COTTER OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #027369, TAX REG. #938300, NYPD OFFICER MARK STEVENSON OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #7312, TAX REG. #953748, AND OTHER NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS ON SAID ARREST AND INVESTIGATION UNDER DOCKET #2016BX020759 N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I-V, AS IT PERTAINS TO THE INCIDENT THAT WAS ALLEGED TO HAVE OCCURRED ON MAY 12, 2016 AND NO OTHER DATE,, jointly and severally without any warrant, order or other legal process and without any legal right, wrongfully and unlawfully arrested the Plaintiff, restrained her and her liberty and then took her into custody to a police station in the County of Bronx, and there charged her with the crimes on Docket No. 2016BX020759. The Plaintiff was thereafter held in custody over the course of approximately two (2) days, or approximately thirty-two (32) hours before being released. The Defendants intentionally confined the Plaintiff without her consent and the confinement was not otherwise privileged by law and, at all times, the Plaintiff was conscious of her confinement. Plaintiff was subjected to strip search with cavity inspection while in custody.

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

12. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "11" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.
13. On or about May 12, 2016, at approximately 3:00 P.M. in the vicinity of the rear of 1035 Longwood Avenue, County of Bronx, State of New York, the

Defendants, NYPD OFFICER NATALIE COTTER OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #027369, TAX REG. #938300, NYPD OFFICER MARK STEVENSON OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #7312, TAX REG. #953748, AND OTHER NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS ON SAID ARREST AND INVESTIGATION UNDER DOCKET #2016BX020759 N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I-V, AS IT PERTAINS TO THE INCIDENT THAT WAS ALLEGED TO HAVE OCCURRED ON MAY 12, 2016 AND NO OTHER DATE, jointly and severally without any valid warrant, order or other legal process and without any legal right, wrongfully and unlawfully imprisoned the Plaintiff, restrained her and her liberty and then took her into custody and causing him to be incarcerated as a detainee in the City of New York's Correctional Facility. The Plaintiff was thereafter held in custody over the course of approximately two (2) days, or approximately thirty-two (32) hours before being released. Plaintiff was also subjected to strip search with cavity inspection while in police custody. The Defendants intentionally confined the Plaintiff without her consent and the confinement was not otherwise privileged by law and, at all times, the Plaintiff was conscious of her confinement.

AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

14. Plaintiff incorporates, repeats, and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "13" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.
15. Upon information and belief, on or about May 12, 2016, with the filing of the criminal court complaint against the Plaintiff, and from that time until the

dismissal of charges against Plaintiff, on or about August 24, 2016, which occurred before the Hon. K. Wilson, in part AP4 of the Bronx Criminal Court, the Defendants, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD OFFICER NATALIE COTTER OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #027369, TAX REG. #938300, NYPD OFFICER MARK STEVENSON OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #7312, TAX REG. #953748, AND OTHER NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS ON SAID ARREST AND INVESTIGATION UNDER DOCKET #2016BX020759 N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I-V, AS IT PERTAINS TO THE INCIDENT THAT WAS ALLEGED TO HAVE OCCURRED ON MAY 12, 2016 AND NO OTHER DATE, *maliciously prosecuted*, an innocent woman without any probable cause whatsoever, by filing or causing a criminal court complaint to be filed in the Criminal Court of the City of New York, Bronx County, for the purpose of falsely accusing the Plaintiff of violations of the criminal laws of the State of New York, and initiating a criminal prosecution against the Plaintiff.

16. The Defendants, jointly and severally, their agents, servants or employees failed to take reasonable steps to stop the prosecution of the Plaintiff and instead maliciously and deliberately provided false and/or incomplete information to the District Attorney's office to induce prosecution of the Plaintiff and due to the absence of probable cause malice can be inferred.
17. The commencement of these criminal proceedings under Docket No. 2016BX020759, was malicious and began in malice and without probable cause, so that the proceedings could succeed by the Defendants in that they

falsified information to cover up their illegal search and seizure, false arrest, and imprisonment of the Plaintiff.

18. As a result of the malicious prosecution, Plaintiff was deprived of his liberty and suffered the humiliation, mental anguish, indignity and frustration of an unjust criminal prosecution. The Plaintiff made multiple court appearances to defend his liberty against these unjust charges.

AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

(This Cause of action only applies against the Individually named Police Officers not the City of New York or officers sued in their official capacity)

19. Plaintiff incorporates, repeats, and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "18" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.
20. Defendants, **NYPD OFFICER NATALIE COTTER OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #027369, TAX REG. #938300, NYPD OFFICER MARK STEVENSON OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #7312, TAX REG. #953748, AND OTHER NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS ON SAID ARREST AND INVESTIGATION UNDER DOCKET #2016BX020759 N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I-V, AS IT PERTAINS TO THE INCIDENT THAT WAS ALLEGED TO HAVE OCCURRED ON MAY 12, 2016 AND NO OTHER DATE**, were at all times relevant, duly appointed and acting officers of the City of New York Police Department.

21. At all times mentioned herein, said police officers were acting under color of law, to wit: the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.
22. Plaintiff, **CARMEN ROMAN**, is and at all times relevant herein, a citizen of the United States. Plaintiff is a resident of Bronx County, and brings this cause of action pursuant to 42 United States Code, Section 1983 and 42 United States Code, Section 1988.
23. The Defendant, **CITY OF NEW YORK**, is a municipality duly incorporated under the laws of the State of New York.
24. On or about May 12, 2016, at approximately 3:00 P.M. in the vicinity of the rear of 1035 Longwood Avenue, County of Bronx, State of New York, the Defendants, **NYPD OFFICER NATALIE COTTER OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #027369, TAX REG. #938300, NYPD OFFICER MARK STEVENSON OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #7312, TAX REG. #953748, AND OTHER NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS ON SAID ARREST AND INVESTIGATION UNDER DOCKET #2016BX020759 N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I-V, AS IT PERTAINS TO THE INCIDENT THAT WAS ALLEGED TO HAVE OCCURRED ON MAY 12, 2016 AND NO OTHER DATE**, armed police, while effectuating the seizure of the Plaintiff, **CARMEN ROMAN**, did search, seize, assault and commit a battery and grab the person of the Plaintiff without a court authorized arrest or search warrant. They did physically seize the person of the Plaintiff during the arrest process in an unlawful and excessive manner. The Plaintiff was falsely arrested, unlawfully imprisoned, illegal searched and seized, and maliciously

prosecuted without the Defendants possessing probable cause to do so. The officer that processed the arrest of the Plaintiff, signed the criminal court complaint against the Plaintiff, and/or communicated with the District Attorney's Office is **NYPD OFFICER NATALIE COTTER OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #027369, TAX REG. #938300**. Pursuant to the criminal court complaint, Officer Cotter was assisted, and arrested the Plaintiff based on allegations made by her fellow officer at the scene, **NYPD OFFICER MARK STEVENSON OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #7312, TAX REG. #953748**.

25. **OTHER NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS WHOSE NAMES ARE UNKNOWN AT THIS TIME, N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I-V**, upon information and belief, assisted in the arrest, transport, processing of the arrest, and investigation that led up to Plaintiff's arrest, however, to what extent is unknown. Plaintiff is unaware of any other officers names, commands, or shields who were or may have been involved in her arrest, processing, or prosecution. Plaintiff is unaware of the description of the officers aside from there being approximately 6-7 officers present, including a "sergeant" in a white dress shirt, two (2) officers in uniform, and the others in plain clothes. The officer who placed the handcuffs on Plaintiff was female officer, **NYPD OFFICER NATALIE COTTER OF THE 41ST PCT., SHIELD #027369, TAX REG. #938300**. Said handcuffs were placed on so tight that Plaintiffs wrists turned red.
26. Due to the lack of probable cause, malice can be inferred.
27. Plaintiff was held in custody over the course of two (2) days, or approximately thrity-two (32) hours, before being released.

28. The charges against Plaintiff were ultimately dismissed, after multiple court appearances, on or about August 24, 2016, before the Hon. K. Wilson, in Part AP4 of the Bronx Criminal Court.
29. The above action of the Defendants resulted in the Plaintiff being deprived of the following rights protected under the United States Constitution:
- a. Freedom from assault to her person;
 - b. Freedom from battery to her person;
 - c. Freedom from illegal search and seizure;
 - d. Freedom from false arrest;
 - e. Freedom from malicious prosecution;
 - f. Freedom from the use of excessive force during the arrest process;
 - g. Freedom from unlawful imprisonment;
 - h. Freedom from loss of his liberty.
 - i. Freedom from unlawful strip search and/or cavity inspection.
30. The Defendants subjected the Plaintiff to such deprivations, either in a malicious or reckless disregard of the Plaintiff's rights or with deliberate indifference to those rights protected under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments of the United States Constitution.
31. The direct and proximate result of the Defendants' acts are that the Plaintiff has suffered severe and permanent injuries of a psychological nature. He was forced to endure pain and suffering, all to his detriment.

AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

32. Plaintiff incorporates, repeats and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "31" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.
33. Defendant, **CITY OF NEW YORK**, has grossly failed to train and adequately supervise its police officers in the fundamental law of arrest, search and seizure especially when its police officers are not in possession of a court authorized arrest warrant and where an individual, especially as here, has not committed a crime and has not resisted arrest, that its police officers should only use reasonable force to effectuate an arrest and the arrest should be based on probable cause.
34. **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** was negligent by failing to implement a policy with its Police Department and instruct police officers who, absent the consent of the Plaintiff (or similarly situated individuals) or without the possession of a court authorized arrest a search warrant, said police officers of the City of New York are not to arrest individuals such as the Plaintiff here where probable cause is lacking and the use of force should only be reasonable when an individual resists arrest and should not be used where a criminal defendant is not resisting arrest.
35. **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** is negligent due to its failure to implement a policy with its Police Department or actively enforce the law, if any of the following are lacking:
1. Probable cause must be present before an individual such as the Plaintiff herein can be arrested.

2. Excessive force cannot be used against an individual who does not physically resist arrest.
 3. An individual who sustains physical injury at the hands of the police during the arrest process should receive prompt medical attention.
36. The foregoing acts, omissions and systemic failures are customs and policies of the **CITY OF NEW YORK** which caused the police officers to falsely arrest, maliciously prosecute, seize illegally and search the Plaintiff commit an assault/battery to her person and denied him prompt medical attention under the belief that they would suffer no disciplinary actions for their failure to take proper or prudent steps in this case.

AS AND FOR AN EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

37. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in paragraphs "1" through "36" as it set forth at length herein.
33. Defendant **CITY OF NEW YORK** was negligent in that prior to and at the time of the acts complained of herein, due to the prior history of the Police Officer Defendants, knew or should have known of the bad disposition of said Defendants or had knowledge of facts that would put a reasonably prudent employer on inquiry concerning their bad disposition and the fact that these officers were not suitable to be hired and employed by the **CITY OF NEW YORK** and that due to their lack of training, these officers should have had adequate supervision so that they would not arrest innocent individuals nor use excessive force during the arrest process.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against the Defendants, together with the costs and disbursements of this action in the amount of damages greater than the jurisdictional limit of any lower court where otherwise have jurisdiction, together with attorneys' fees and costs for bringing this case and punitive damages.

Dated: Bayside, New York
May 17, 2017

Yours, etc.

JOHN R. DEPAOLA & ASSOCIATES PLLC

BY: **JOHN R. DEPAOLA, ESQ.**
Attorneys for Plaintiff(s)
42-40 Bell Boulevard Suite 500
Bayside, New York 11361
(718) 281-4000

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
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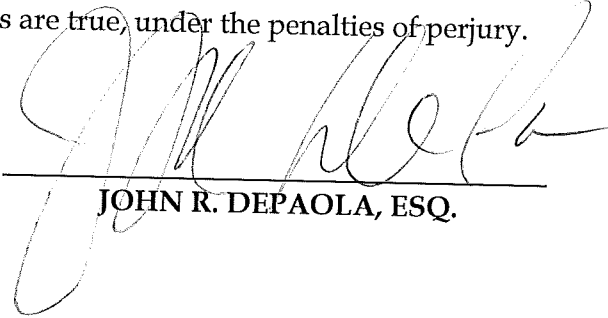
VERIFICATION

Defendants.
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I, JOHN R. DEPAOLA, an attorney admitted to practice in the courts of New York State, state that I am a member of the firm of JOHN R. DEPAOLA & ASSOCIATES PLLC, the attorneys of record for Plaintiffs in the within action; I have read the foregoing and know the contents thereof; the same is true to my own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief, and as to those matters I believe it to be true. The reason this verification is made by me and not by Plaintiff is because Plaintiff resides outside the county where deponent maintains his office.

I affirm that the foregoing statements are true, under the penalties of perjury.

Dated: Bayside, New York
May 17, 2017



JOHN R. DEPAOLA, ESQ.

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SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT

JOHN R. DEPAOLA & ASSOCIATES PLLC
BY: JOHN R. DEPAOLA, ESQ.
Attorney for Plaintiff(s)
42-40 Bell Boulevard, Ste. 500
Bayside, NY 11361
Tel. (718) 281-4000

To: CORPORATION COUNSEL OF THE CITY OF NEW YORK

Attorney(s) for Defendants

Service of a copy of the within is hereby admitted.

Dated

Attorney(s) for